doned. After many twists and turns, the local hostility to anyone who seeks to learn about the fate of the Jewish population becomes apparent. Eventually the Kalina brothers discover the truth: the Polish inhabitants of Gurówka had butchered their Jewish neighbors. *Pokłosie* triggered yet another debate on the extent to which Poles should be seen as accountable for the fate of the Jews and whether those who made the film were guilty of treason.

The inspiring story of Polish rescuers of Jews has also become a highly charged emotional issue, especially with the ongoing discussion of the propriety of erecting a monument to the Polish Righteous among the Nations alongside the new museum of Polish Jewry, which also divided Polish Jewish society. Critics, most notably the historians connected with the Polish Center for Holocaust Research, maintain that the righteous (including the best-known among them, Irena Sendlerowa and Jan Karski) have been treated in instrumental fashion as a means of countering the exposure of Polish complicity in the destruction of Polish Jewry.[16] They also emphasized that the very fact that some Polish rescuers, including one in Jedwabne, had hesitated to come forward with their stories for fear of opprobrium on the part of neighbors and the surrounding society was a telling commentary on the ambience in Poland.

Even on the highest level, there has been considerable resistance to the findings of courageous and critical Polish historians. For example, in an interview with *Haaretz* during an official visit to Israel in February 2011, Poland's Oxford-educated foreign minister, Radosław Sikorski claimed, "The Holocaust that took place on our soil was conducted against our will by someone else." To deflect criticism, Sikorski lashed out at Washington for its failure to come to the rescue of Polish Jewry once it had been targeted for destruction.[17]

In October 2011, when Princeton University hosted a prestigious international conference devoted to "The Holocaust in Poland: New Findings and New Interpretations," a senior Polish diplomat in New York actually protested against the parley's title, insisting that one could infer from it that Poles (and not Germans) were the prime perpetrators of the destruction of Polish Jewry. Undoubtedly, the stiffest resistance has come from certain nationalist scholars, who for many years have enjoyed the lavish backing of the IPN, which saw defending the good name of Poland as its sacrosanct mission. Among the most notable of these is Marek Jan Chodakiewicz, a lecturer at the Institute for World Politics in Washington, D.C. In 2008, the IPN hastily published a Polish edition of his 2004 book *After the Holocaust: Polish-Jewish Relations in the Wake of World War II* that was touted as an antidote to *Fear* and widely distributed despite the fact that it had been

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